Romans

God's Judgment of
The Moral Man
Ch. 2

https://tinyurl.com/RomeGospel

The Predicament of Mankind

"The wrath of God is revealed…" "…For all have sinned…"

***FAITH**, chapters 1-8*

- ***1-3 Sin (All men are without excuse.)***
- *4-5 Salvation*
- *6-8 Sanctification*

Romans 1 : The "Pagan Man"

- *For **Suppressing** God's Truth (v.18)*
- *For **Ignoring** God's Revelation (v.19-20)*
- *For **Perverting** God's Glory (v.21-23)*

Romans 2 : The "Moral Man"

- ***Seven principles of God's righteous judgement***

Romans 3 : The "Religious Man"

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REVIEW

The Pagan Man - They Became Fools…

Man's refusal to acknowledge and glorify God leads to a downward path:

First, worthless thinking;

Next, moral insensitivity; and

Then, religious stupidity as seen in idol-worship!

The witness to God in nature is so clear and so constant that ignoring it is indefensible.

The pagan man's condemnation is based not on their rejecting Christ of whom they have not heard,

But sinning against the Light that they do have. *2 Corinthians 8:12*

Case Study: Sodom

Ezekiel 16:48-50

For what cause did God "take them away"?

Was this "fair" of God?

The first step in the revelation of the righteousness that God provides for people by faith is to set forth our **need** for it because we are under God's judgment. We are born into a fallen race. The human race stands condemned before God and is helpless and hopeless apart from God's grace.

What Law is at play in this judgment scenario?

The Law of Sin and Death (Romans 8:2)

Is this a real law?

Compare to other "natural laws" like gravity, cause and effect, entropy, others.

Review our "court-room" scenario… The 3 men in the dock; the Judge; the Jury… What type of glasses are we all wearing?

Is pagan mankind guilty?

How do you know?

Do you now judge the Pagan man guilty?

Read Romans 2:1-3 (PAUSE)

What about Matthew 7:1-2 ???

What about I Cor. 2:13-16 ???

What is the common thread? A common measuring stick that we all possess and recognize?

Aren't we (i.e. the jurist) now also defendants?

Read I Corinthians 2:13-16

How can we "know" anything? ("But we have the mind of Christ.") How is this possible? John 18:37

What is meant by v15? What is meant by "rightly judged"?

Is this passage a clue as to the meaning of Jesus' statement, "Everyone who is of the Truth hears My voice." …?

Is this a clue as to the power of the glasses we are given to wear as jurors within the Romans 1-3 court-room?

What is the correlation within I Cor 3:9-15 …?

Review how the court-room changes as we enter chapter 2.

Let us not confuse Romans 2 with Revelation 20… at Judgment Day (Rev 20), there will be no reasoning or preaching; only condemnation; based upon the Principles of God's Judgment.

The Agent of divine judgment is Jesus Christ. John 5:22, 27; Acts 17:29-31

Now that Jesus is the divine judge within our court-room…

What does this say about God's "fairness"?

The Moral Man

Seven Principles of God's Righteous Judgment

(1) According to Truth

*"**But we know that the judgment of God is according to truth against those who practice such things**." v.2*

- *Self-righteousness*
- *Condemnation before investigation*
- *The only barrier to receiving the Truth is the assumption that you already have it. (pride vs. "ask, seek, knock" humility)*

(2) According to Accumulated Guilt

***"…treasuring up for yourself wrath…"** v.5*

- *Not until the last evil result of a life of sin can the final condemnation of the sinner be known.*
- ***Unless**… John 5:24; Romans 8:1; (The Good News!)*

3

What is the greatest thought that ever entered the mind of Man?

"My responsibility to my Maker!" Daniel Webster

How does God deal with Man individually? Ezekiel 18…? Mankind Corporately?

According to Truth…

- **In this court-room, we are privileged to be wear (as jurists) the glasses of God's Truth… to see the evidence with the Mind of Christ (1 Cor 2:15).**
- **Emphatically! We MUST always wear these when doing Kingdom work (in humility, planting, watering, answering, with compassion).**

Seven principles dealing with how God will decide and respond to mankind.

(1) According to Truth

- Do you think that you will escape judgment – You? Self righteousness is a death sentence that we all share in. (Ezekiel 16:48-50)
- The principle that keeps us in ignorance is condemnation (coming to a conclusion) before investigation.
- v4, Not only do we feel ourselves innocent, but the riches of God should be leading us to repentance.
- Note God's progressive degrees – goodness, forbearance, and longsuffering – in responding to our ingratitude.

(2) According to Accumulated Guilt

- The First Law of Holes… stop digging.
- Ezekiel 16:49-50 – Example Sodom and Gomorrah – pride; more than homosexuality
- Luke 17:28-30
- Prosperity always feeds pride; it's easy to be humble when you are poor.

The Moral Man

Seven Principles of God's Righteous Judgment

(3) According to Works

*"**Who will render to each one according to his deeds:**" v.6*

- *Revelation 20:13-15*
- *Not a revelation of the way of salvation, but a general description of the character of the saved.*
- *"Doing good" demonstrates a heart that is right with God.*

(4) Without Respect of Persons

*"**For there is no respect of persons with God.**" v.11*

- *Just recompense by God is without regard to:*
  - *Ethnic background or any other consideration,*
  - *Except what each person has done.*
- *Law – specific and general (according to the Light given)*

The Moral Man

Seven Principles of God's Righteous Judgment

(5) According to Obedience

*"**…for not the hearers of the law are just in the sight of God, but the doers of the law will be justified;…**" v.13*

- *Addresses the false comfort or false peace (i.e. false teaching) of justification by merely "knowing God's Truth".*
- *Gospel speaks of the "obedience of faith".*
- *Habitual conduct reveals one's heart.*

(6) According to Secrets of the Heart

***"In the day when God will judge the secrets of men by Jesus Christ, according to my gospel."** v.16*

- *In accord with theme of verses 2:5-13*
- *Judgment will deal with men's secrets. 1 Cor. 4:5*

The Moral Man

Seven Principles of God's Judgment

(7) According to Reality

Romans 2:17-29

- *Specifically addressing the Jew; exemplar of the religious person; who is proud of the law, but not keeping it.*
- *Religion – man's attempt to cover himself.*
- *Basis of Jewish Pride*
  - *Being called a Jew*
  - *Relied on the Law*
  - *Boasting of God*
  - *Knowing God's Will*
  - *Being instructed of the Law*
- *"**For 'the name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles because of you'…"** Isaiah 52:5; Ezekiel 36:22*
- *Reality counts with God… the true "Jew" exemplar is one who is circumcised in heart; one who seeks to walk in accordance with the revealed will of God.*

The Moral Man

Conscience, v. 14-15

Conscience is an important part of human nature…

- *But, not an absolutely trustworthy indicator of what is right.*
- *Romans 2:14,15 are an explanation of verses 2:12,13*

One's conscience can be…

- *"good" - Acts 23:1; 1 Timothy 1:5,19*
- *"clear" - Acts 24:16; 1 Timothy 3:9; 2 Timothy 1:3; Hebrews 13:18*

But, it can also be…

- *"guilty" - Hebrews 10:22*
- *"corrupted" - Titus 1:15*
- *"weak" - 1 Corinthians 8:7,10,12*
- *"seared" - 1 Timothy 4:2*

By way of the blood of Jesus Christ, our conscience may be…

- *"cleansed" - Hebrews 9:14*

Meaning (Why are we here?)

Revealing Human Life as Purposeful and Precious

Matthew 5:13-16 *You are the salt of the earth; but if the salt loses its flavor, how shall it be seasoned? It is then good for nothing but to be thrown out and trampled underfoot by men. You are the light of the world. A city that is set on a hill cannot be hidden. Nor do they light a lamp and put it under a basket, but on a lampstand, and it gives light to all who are in the house. Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works and glorify your Father in heaven.*

John 10:10 *The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly.*

Ephesians 2:10 *For we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand that we should walk in them.*

John 15:4-5 *Abide in Me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, unless it abides in the vine, neither can you, unless you abide in Me. "I am the vine, you are the branches. He who abides in Me, and I in him, bears much fruit; for without Me you can do nothing. … By this My Father is glorified, that you bear much fruit; so you will be My disciples.*

Philippians 1:21 *For to me, to live is Christ, and to die is gain.*

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Meaning (Why are we here?)

- **Matthew 5:13–16** : Jesus tells His disciples they are “the salt of the earth” and “the light of the world,” giving them a sense of purpose: to preserve goodness, illuminate truth, and lead others to glorify God.
- **John 10:10** : Jesus says He came so that people “may have life, and have it abundantly.” This suggests that meaningful existence is found in Him, defined by a fullness of life rather than mere survival.
- **John 15:1–11** : Using the vine and branches metaphor, Jesus explains that abiding in Him leads to fruitful living. This indicates that human purpose is fulfilled in relationship with Christ, resulting in spiritual growth and joy.
- **Ephesians 2:10** : Declares believers are God’s workmanship, created in Christ for good works—implying a purposeful existence rooted in God’s design.
- **John 15:4–5, 8** : The vine and branches analogy shows life’s meaning is found in abiding in Christ, bearing fruit that glorifies God.
- **Philippians 1:21** : Paul finds life’s meaning in Christ, stating, “To live is Christ,” which suggests our ultimate purpose involves knowing and serving Him.

Morality (How should we live?)

Upholding Divine Law as the Moral Guide

Matthew 5-7 *(Sermon on the Mount : Jesus' most comprehensive moral instruction; teaching on humility, righteousness, love for enemies, purity, integrity, and trusting God – provides an ethical framework that goes beyond conformity to internal transformation.)*

Mark 12:30-31 *And the second, like it, is this: 'YOU SHALL LOVE YOUR NEIGHBOR AS YOURSELF.' There is no other commandment greater than these."*

Luke 10:25-37 *(Parable of the Good Samaritan : Jesus uses this parable to redefine who our "neighbor" is and exhorts compassionate, sacrificial love as the highest moral responsibility.)*

John 13:34-35 *A new commandment I give to you, that you love one another; as I have loved you, that you also love one another. By this all will know that you are My disciples, if you have love for one another.*

Romans 12:1-2 *I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that you present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your reasonable service. And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, that you may prove what is that good and acceptable and perfect will of God.*

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Morality (How should we live?)

- **Matthew 5–7** (Sermon on the Mount) : Jesus' most comprehensive moral instruction—teaching on humility, righteousness, love for enemies, purity, integrity, and trusting God—provides an ethical framework that goes beyond external conformity to internal transformation.
- **Mark 12:30–31** : Jesus summarizes the Law by instructing His followers to love God with their whole being and to love their neighbors as themselves. This dual command shapes moral priorities and principles for living.
- **Luke 10:25–37** (Parable of the Good Samaritan) : Jesus uses a parable to redefine who our "neighbor" is and exhorts compassionate, sacrificial love as the highest moral responsibility.
- **John 13:34–35** : Jesus commands His disciples to love one another as He has loved them, making self-giving love the defining mark of Christian morality.
- **Matthew 5–7** (Sermon on the Mount) : Jesus provides ethical teachings that set the moral standard for His followers, emphasizing inner transformation, love for enemies, and righteousness exceeding that of religious formalism.
- **Romans 12:1–2** : Encourages believers to present themselves as living sacrifices, be transformed by renewing their minds, and thereby discern God's will—moral living through spiritual renewal.
- **Galatians 5:22–23** : Lists the Fruit of the Spirit, virtues like love, joy, peace, and self-control that form the moral character of a Christian.
- **James 1:22–27** : Urges action, not just hearing the Word, and highlights caring for orphans and widows as a hallmark of true religion.